



NVIDIA turns to liquid cooling

NVIDIA plans to reduce the energy use of big tech companies' AI models by using liquid-cooled graphic cards. <https://digit.in/jun22-15>



Twitter's co-founder steps down

Twitter's co-founder and former CEO Jack Dorsey stepped down as company's board of directors. <https://digit.in/jun22-19>

delivery to the northern islands takes a lot of time.

France

DPDgroup a subsidiary of Le Groupe La Poste France's national postal service has been reverberating the idea of drone-delivered packages since 2014. In partnership with a French drone-making company, Atechsys, a stretch of land of about 15 km between Saint Maximin-la-Sainte-Baume and Pourrières in the Provence region of France has already seen package delivery by drones. The packages can carry parcels up to a weight of 3 kg at an elevation of not more than 19 km at a



maximum speed of 31 km/hr. French Civil Aviation Authority (DGAC) authorised DPDgroup back in December 2016. The vision of Le Groupe La Poste is similar to that of Royal Mail, as they wanted to reach remote and mountainous regions by delivering packages without fail and on time.

The second line of delivery by drones between Fontanil-Cornillon to the village of Mont-Saint-Martin was also authorised in 2019. This line uses a mobile terminal as the base of the drone for the take-off and return. The driver parks his vehicle at dedicated parking spots and the drone does the rest of the work. The parcel will be dropped off at fixed dropping stations. The round trip drive to Mont-Saint-



Martin usually takes 30 minutes which the drone has cut down to 8 minutes.

Ireland

Oranmore, a small town in western Ireland, is seeing a revolution in drones delivering food and groceries. Manna, an Irish startup company, has taken the 8000-people-strong town into the grasp of a mass drone delivery service. Almost 2000-3000 drone flights are taken every day by the company to deliver orders in Oranmore. The drones fly at an elevation of 200 feet. When it reaches the destination address, it scans the area with radar and lidar for a safe descent



spot and comes down to about 80 feet before the package is dropped safely, attached to a string. Manna's drones can fly at a speed of almost 80 km/hr. Ice cream, eggs, and even coffee are delivered within minutes of ordering. The notification on your mobile pops, "Look up, we're here!"

Manna has tied up with food delivery services such as Just Eat in Oranmore. The drones sit on the roof of local supermarket Tesco in close proximity to the eateries, ready to deliver food packages.

China

Other countries such as China and the U.S. have also implemented drone services to deliver parcels,



even as Amazon struggles with its drones, as reported by Bloomberg. Meituan in China is similar to Manna in delivering food packages to people. The only difference is that designated kiosks are used for delivery unlike in Oranmore where the drones hover right outside the homes of the customer. Even though the drone delivery service is available for now, in a small area of Shenzhen, it well and truly looks like the future of delivery services.

WHEN IS THE TAKE-OFF?

The application of drones in post delivery seems like a feasible and viable option even though it is in its nascent stages. The services are limited to smaller operations and a full-fledged drone service across the globe might take a few more years to come to fruition. Several factors have to be incorporated before we can see a sky full of drones carrying our packages. The most important of which are security and safety. This is where the regulations and licensing factor comes in.

Drone fliers should have a license and the devices must pass a safety signature, which is the present barricade to Amazon's PrimeAir where test drones have caught fire and crash landed. Software that is used to fly the drones should also come with an address verification system to make sure your coffee doesn't reach your neighbour. Once the industry expands, the cost effectiveness will also have to factor in. Greater reach will mean bigger drones. And bigger drones will mean more emissions. Couple all of that with renewed discussions about robots and technologies eating up job opportunities for human beings.

If technology innovation can green mark all the amber zones, drone postal service could become a global phenomenon. It is a step towards the future. The discussion of if we want to look up and see drones is something that can hopefully happen sooner than we expect. 